AHEAD WITH KK

Win the last 10 steps: a checklist for shops on a crowded market street

for anyone who sells on a street full of rivals (jewellers, textiles, electronics, wholesale)

The idea. On a street like Avenue Road or Kumbarpet, the street brings the buyer, not your shop. Buyers come because they can compare. Your job is not to pull people to the street. It is to win the few steps between "walking past" and "standing at your counter".

☐ 1. A board people can read while walking

- Stand 10 steps away on the opposite side. Can you read what you sell in 2 seconds? If not, cut words.
- One line in Kannada, one in English. Your speciality in the biggest letters, your name second.

☐ 2. The price (or a "starting from") in view

- Put 3 to 5 price tags where people can see them from the step, not only inside the glass.
- If prices change daily, use a small board you can rewrite: "Bangles from 120".

☐ 3. One thing they can touch at the doorway

- A tray, a rack or a sample card at hand height near the entry. Touching lowers the step to walking in.
- Keep it tidy and full. An empty tray reads as "old stock".

☐ 4. Make your shop easy to find again

- Many buyers compare, leave, and come back. Give them a reason to remember you: a number on the board, a visiting card with a photo of your best piece, or a WhatsApp number in big digits.

☐ 5. Be the one that answers fast on WhatsApp

- A buyer who saw five shops will message two. Reply within minutes during market hours, with photo + price.

☐ 6. Light the counter, not the ceiling

- Bright light on the product and the price tag. Shadowy counters lose to the neighbour.

☐ 7. Count one number for 2 weeks

- Pick one: walk-ins, WhatsApp enquiries, or bills. Change one thing from this list, then compare.

Practical steps, not guaranteed results. Try one, measure it, keep what works.